The *fourth working assumption* is that the command channels within the system should be as short as possible, from the "production floor" of the agent in the field up to the political decision maker. This ensures that the agent in the field understands not only the literal orders and instructions but also the "spirit of the commander." It also allows the commander to develop an intimate familiarity with the people in the field and to better understand and judge the information that they pass on. In general, the organizational culture of bodies with a relatively short command channel is better than those with a long channel. In "flat" organizations, the individual's sense of partnership, and hence his or her sense of responsibility, are more developed, and the organizational culture is generally characterized by an aspiration for excellence.

An intelligence organization needs money, and a lot of it. In systems like ours, which deal with life-and-death, existential issues, the norm in the past was to see intelligence as having no price. Over the years, tools for the production of intelligence have become more sophisticated, and their cost has reached a level that is prohibitive, even to a country under threat. The organization then finds itself in a situation in which it must act within a given budget and decide which priorities take precedence in apportioning it. This was not my favorite task when I was head of the organization, and I assume that others serving in similar positions also did not take great pleasure in it. Regardless, it is a vital task and requires the attention and discretion of the organization's highest echelons.

Trust and support between the appointed heads of the professional bodies and the political echelon are an imperative condition for the ability of the various bodies to fulfill their tasks. The intelligence system operates in the context of existential threats to the people and to the state. The potential damage that could arise from a mistake could be critical. Every person in this system is required to have a very high threshold for taking huge risks. Trust and support between the professional directors and those in charge at the political level are a crucial condition for success. Once trust is broken, support follows suit and there is almost no way to fix the situation. In such a case, the best thing is for the professional chief to resign.

I headed the Mossad for seven years and served under three prime ministers from two different parties. When I am asked about my greatest achievement, I respond, with a smile that reflects a lot of truth, that it is the